

Off the Shelf



Midnight Club II

Become a member

Midnight Club II hails from the land of consoles. Unsurprisingly, it scoffs, it smirks, and generally looks down upon any-and-all without a good game-pad. So we sincerely ask you to get yourself one.

The illegal street driving that serves as the centre of the *Fast and the Furious* films is very much present in the game, and other elements such as rivals, cops, and one-dimensional women are rendered faithfully. Where a *Need For Speed* throws a set of cars at you, this game will present just one. You have to win the rest, son! Winning the wheels requires overcoming



It's even more fun to actually do it

challenges that members of the club throw at you. Like a good game, the hurdles ramp in difficulty and style, relent-

less in their demand that you get better with every success. No resting on laurels here. The game succeeds in wiggling a car-rot at just the right distance from your salivating mouth—a smudge too far and one would have given up in disgust, a sliver too close and one would have put the game down as too easy.

The offering works and is fun. The graphics serve their purpose—nothing fancy and flashy, but pretty enough to look at. They walk the fine line between offering good looks and being undemanding on your system. *Midnight Club II* is a great game. Give it a try.

Genre: Racing ■ **Developer:** Rockstar Games ■ **Publisher:** Take Two Interactive ■ **System Requirements:** 800 MHz CPU, 128 MB RAM, GeForce2/Radeon 8500, 1.4 GB HDD space, DirectX 9.0 ■ **Price:** NA ■ **Web site:** www.midnightclub2.com
Rating: ★★★★★



BloodRayne

Bring an umbrella

Someone, somewhere finally woke up to the fact that sex sells. Someone then read a couple of World War II comic books to get up to speed on 'that entire history and Nazi thing', and *voila!* *BloodRayne* was born—like a Britney Spears video that purports to be sexy and steamy, but only succeeds in coming across as lame and tacky. Be afraid. Very, very afraid.

The story is very erratically delivered. The game takes you from one sub-plot to another via poorly ordered and edited cut-scenes. What is very obvious is the game's sexual overtones. The weapons are the only highlights of this game, but in the end all boils down to light guns, heavy guns and explosives.



Let's go grab a bite....

The voice acting is below par, and the dialogues are quite lame to listen to. The plot is almost non-existent: the only

objective is to kill a bunch of select enemies, be they Nazi officers or supernatural creatures.

However, *BloodRayne* does show some great potential and could have been good if only the developers had put in as much effort into the plot as they have with the 'eye-candy'. The combat animation is good, but combat itself is up to the mark. Game difficulty is polarised—most of the boss fights are unfairly tough and those with lesser denizens are ridiculously easy.

BloodRayne has missed on key elements, which makes it a very uninspiring title. And yes, they're making a movie out of this title. And guess who's financing it—the Germans. Go figure!

Genre: Tactical Shooter ■ **Developer:** Terminal Reality ■ **Publisher:** Majesco ■ **System requirements:** 733 MHz CPU, 128 MB RAM, 2 GB hard disk space, 200 MB virtual memory, 64 MB GeForce2/Radeon 8500 video card ■ **Price:** Rs 920 ■ **Web site:** www.bloodrayne.com
Rating: ★★★★★